

Jorge Luis Montero Mestre

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Research Areas

Primary: Environmental and Resource Economics, Political Economy of Natural Resources, Conservation Policy.
Secondary: Applied Econometrics, Causal Inference, Remote Sensing and Geospatial Analysis.

Current Appointments

Universidad de Los Andes <i>Post-Doctoral Fellow & Adjunct Professor</i>	2025 – <i>Bogota, Colombia</i>
SDG Nexus Network - Justus Liebig University of Gießen <i>Research Associate</i>	2025 – <i>Gießen, Germany (Remote)</i>

Education

Universidad de Los Andes <i>PhD in Economics</i>	2020 – 2025 <i>Bogota, Colombia</i>
Justus Liebig University of Gießen <i>Visiting Student Researcher</i>	2024 <i>Gießen, Germany</i>
<i>Dissertation Title: Three Empirical Essays on Marine Economics and Illegal Fishing</i> <i>Advisor: Jorge Maldonado</i> <i>Committee: Sandra Aguilar, Andries Richter, Mario Rueda</i>	
Universidad de Los Andes <i>M.Sc. in Economics</i>	2020 – 2023 <i>Bogota, Colombia</i>
Universidad de Cartagena <i>B.Sc. in Economics</i>	2013 – 2019 <i>Cartagena, Colombia</i>
Universidad Complutense de Madrid <i>Exchange Student</i>	2018 <i>Madrid, Spain</i>

Research

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Jorge Maldonado, Rocío Moreno-Sánchez & **Jorge Montero-Mestre** (2027). Deforestation in the Colombian Amazon Biome: Socioeconomic and Socio-Environmental Conflict Drivers. *World Development*. [🔗](#)

Jorge Marco, Miguel Ramirez, William Martinez, Iván Lizarazo, **Jorge Montero-Mestre**, Jorge Forero, Ali Kharrazi, Nadia Combariza & Alicia Correa (2025) Network-Based Assessment of Multi-Scale Resilience in the Water-Energy-Land-Food Nexus: A Case Study in the Colombian Caribbean. *Total Environment Advances*. [🔗](#)

Working papers

How Fuel Subsidy Reductions Reshaped Fishing Activity: Evidence from China's Policy Reform in the East China Sea. With *Jorge Marco*. **R&R - 2nd round. Environmental and Resources Economics**. [🔗](#)

Illuminating the Shadows: Assessing Compliance and Effectiveness in Marine Protected Areas with Satellite Imagery and AIS Data. With *Jorge Maldonado*. **Under review. Marine Policy**. [🔗](#)

Natural Resource Dependence, Livelihood Diversification and Well-Being in a Small-Scale Fishery: Evidence from a Dynamic Household Production Model. With *Jorge Maldonado, Rocío Moreno-Sánchez & Myriam Vargas-Morales*. **Under Review. Environment and Development Economics**.

Unmasking the Threat to Property Rights: Unauthorized Fishing Activity during the COVID-19 Pandemic. With *Jorge Bonilla*. **In Preparation.** [↗](#)

Selected works in progress

Deforestation and Downstream Hydrological Risk: Hydrological Externalities and Watershed Governance in Colombia

Unpacking the Extractive Frontier: Sequential Exploration, Physical Drilling, and Environmental Degradation in Colombia. With *Jaime Polanco-Jimenez (KU Leuven)*

Agricultural-Rural Credits and Deforestation in Colombia. With *Myriam Vargas (FCDS)*, & *Cristian Salas (FCDS)*

Rural Livelihoods under Climate Stress: Agriculture, Livestock, and Food Security in Colombia and Kyrgyzstan. With *Begayim Emileva (UCA)*, & *Martin Petrick (JLU)*

Voluntary Conservation or Selection? Evaluating the Impact of Private Nature Reserves on Deforestation in Colombia.

Teaching Experience

Courses Taught

- **Universidad de los Andes**

Environmental and natural resource economics for graduate students	2025 –
Statistical & R Programming Workshop Seminar	2024 - 2025
Microsoft Excel Workshop Seminar for undergraduate students	2023 - 2025

- **Technical University of Munich**

WELF Nexus and Resilience for graduate students (<i>short course</i>)	2024
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Teaching Assistant

- **Universidad de los Andes**

Impact Evaluation for graduate students (Prof. Rachid Laajaj)	2025 –
Econometrics for undergraduate students (Prof. Oscar Becerra)	2022 - 2024
Environmental and natural resource economics for graduate students (Prof. Jorge Marco)	2022 - 2023

Graduate Supervision

- **Master's Thesis Advisor — Universidad de los Andes**

• Harold Acuña & José Cuervo.	2025 –
• Manuel Navarro.	2026 –
• Jorge Viafara.	2026 –

Conference & Invited Presentations

Leibniz Zentrum für Marine Tropenforschung Seminar (Bremen, 2026), SDGNexus Network Seminar Series (Gießen, 2026), University of Girona, Economic Department Seminar (Girona, 2026), Water Security and Climate Change Conference (Tashkent, 2025), the 1st LAERE Annual Meeting (Bogotá, 2025), the Center for International Development and Environmental Research (ZEU)-Colloquium (Gießen, 2024), PhD/Postdoc Seminar, Department of Production and Resource Economics at the Technical University of Munich (Munich, 2024), the 20th IEA World Congress (Medellín, 2023), the 17th EfD Annual Meeting (Accra, 2023), the 16th EfD Annual Meeting (Kampala, 2022), the 8th NENRE EfD-Chile Annual Meeting (Parral, 2022), and the National Colloquium of Doctoral Students in Economics (Cali, 2022).

Professional Services

Journal Reviewer

- Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics (JBEE)

Conference Reviewer

- World Congress of Environmental and Resource Economists (WCERE)

Selection committee

SDG Nexus Network PhD Scholarship - JLU, Gießen, Germany.

Academic Organization

Co-Organizer, SDGnexus Network International Training School 2026, “Flowing Towards Uncertainty: Addressing Land Use and Climate Change in Andean River Systems”, Bogotá, Colombia.

Grants

Flexible Seed Funds - ZEU

Co-Principal Investigator (8.500 €)

2026

Gießen, Germany

Wageningen University & Research

WIMEK Research fellowship (5.450 €)

2024

Wageningen, Netherland

Other Information

Programming skills: Stata, R, and Python.

GIS skills: ArcGis, QGis

Languages: Spanish (*native*), English (*fluent*), German (*basic*)

Personal Information: Married (2020). Two children: i) born 2021, ii) born 2025.